Ali N. Whatley (Masters Student)

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Education

Georgia Institute of Technology: MS International Affairs
Aug 2025 - May 2027 (expected)

- Tracks: Science & Technology and International Security
- Planned Certificates:
    - International Security & Aerospace Systems
    - Emerging Technologies & Proliferation
- Relevant Courses: Science, Technology, International Affairs I, Introduction to System of Systems Engineering Principles, Empirical Research Methods, International Security, & Politics, Tech and Proliferation

Georgia State University: B.S. Economics, B.A. Political Science
Aug. 2022 - August 2025

- Certificate: Global Scholar
- Relevant Courses: Nuclear Weapons and International Politics, Econometrics and Applications, Causes of War, & Methods of Regression Analysis
- Relevant Graduate Level Courses: Introduction to Mathematics for Economics, Research in Economics, & Intro to Data Management and Analysis

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Research

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Research Interest

Defense Policy and Strategy—especially the Defense Industrial Base and state approaches to preparing for and sustaining warfare; Technological Proliferation, with a focus on nuclear and dual-use systems; Energy Security and Civilian Readiness (including conscription); International Security

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Experience

Independent Study: Organizational Decision-Making in High-Risk Technologies
Georgia Tech, Sam Nunn School | Dr. Margaret E. Kosal | Jan 2026 - May 2026
Research examining the interaction between organizational structure and technological complexity in nuclear governance, using the 1954 Castle Bravo accident as a case study.

ASDL Grand Challenge: Year-long group research project on Energy Systems and National Security focused on creating a tabletop tool to aid policy makers to facilitate quantitative policy-making decisions for tactical responses to energy shocks.

Research in Economics: During this semester-long course, research focused on natural gas pricing due to the deregulation of natural gas markets.

- An Examination of Natural Gas Deregulation

Pollitik Lab – Political Popularity Project

Georgia State University, EPIC Program | Dr. Ryan Carlin | Year-long collaboration

Contributed data collection and analysis for the Executive Approval Project, an NSF-funded multi-university collaboration tracking global leader approval ratings. Conducted comparative analysis of nations' electorates using cross-national public opinion data.

- Sample posts:
  - Jimmy Carter, Farmer, Politician, Humanitarian, Dies
  - From North Korea with Love: North Korean Provocations and South Korean Rallies

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Skills

Stata: *Intermediate*

- Stata Experience gained during a research project within economics

Excel: *Expert*

- Experience focused on data cleaning and data analysis

R: *Intermediate*

- R experience in data management and research

Python: *Intermediate*

- Currently taking courses through Datacamp to gain knowledge of Python for data analytics

SysML: *Intermediate*

NetLogo: *Beginner*

Languages

- English - *Native*
- French - *Intermediate*

Work and Internship Experience

U.S. Senate - Senator Ossoff - Washington, D.C. - Fall 2026

Sam Nunn fellowship in National Security

U.S. Department of Labor - Bureau of Labor Statistics - Atlanta, GA - May 2024 - August 2024

Student Volunteer (Research intern)

- Aided BLS staff with daily tasks utilizing R and Excel.
- Worked on a time series project utilizing randomized BLS data.

- Aided in the updating of certain aspects of BLS code, Naics, and other tools.

Conferences and Forums

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Conferences

"Nuclear Testing and Normal Accidents: A Case Study of The Castle Bravo Accident" Southeast Nuclear Research Conference | Panel Presentation | Athens, GA | May 2026

"Nuclear Testing and Normal Accidents: A Case Study of The Castle Bravo Accident" IAC Annual Student Research Conference | Poster Presentation | Atlanta, GA | March 2026

- Winner, Best Research Award

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Forum

National Security Forum: AI & National Security | Invited Participant | Warner-Robins, GA | February 2025